Requirements Specification

Use this Requirements Specification template to document the requirements for your software project, including priority and approval.

Executive Summary

1.1 Software project Overview

Describe this software project and its intended audience, or provide a link or reference to the software project charter.

1.2 Purpose and Scope of this Specification

Describe the purpose of this specification and its intended audience. I am the customer so I am the intended audience.

2. Description

Describe the general factors that affect the software project and its requirements. This section should contain background information, do not state detailed or specific requirements.

2.1 Software project Context

How does this software project relate to other software projects?

Is it independent and self-contained?

Does it interface with a variety of related systems?

Describe these relationships or use a diagram to show the major components of the larger system, interconnections, and external interfaces.

2.2 User Characteristics

Create general customer profiles for each type of user who will be using the software. Profiles should include:

- Student/faculty/staff/other
- experience
- technical expertise
- other general characteristics that may influence the software project

2.3 Assumptions

List any assumptions that affect the requirements, for example, equipment availability, user expertise, etc.

3. Requirements

- Describe all system requirements in enough detail for designers to design a system satisfying the requirements and testers to verify that the system satisfies requirements.

3.1 User Interface Requirements

In addition to functions required, describe the characteristics of each interface between the software project and its users (e.g., required screen formats/organization, report layouts, menu structures, error and other messages, or function keys).

3.2 Usability

Include any specific usability requirements, for example, Learnability

- The user documentation and help should be complete
- The help should be context sensitive and explain how to achieve common tasks. The system should be easy to learn

3.2.1 Availability

Include specific and measurable requirements for:

- Hours of operation
- Level of availability required
- Coverage for geographic areas

3.3 Security

3.3.1 Protection

Specify the factors that will protect the system from malicious or accidental access, modification, disclosure, destruction, or misuse. For example:

- encryption
- activity logging, historical data sets

4. User Scenarios/Use Cases

Provide a summary of the major functions that the software project will perform. Organize the functions to be understandable to the customer or a first time reader. Include use cases and business scenarios, or provide a link to a separate document (or documents). A business scenario:

- Describes a significant business need
- Shows the “Actors” and where they fit in the business model